ZCAS UNIVERSITY

SCHOOL OF COMPUTING, TECHNOLOGY & APPLIED SCIENCES

CIT5242 STRATEGIC PROJECT MANAGEMENT

FINAL EXAMINATION

WEDNESDAY 27TH NOVEMBER 2024

14:00 HRS TO 17:00 HRS

TIME ALLOWED : (3 HRS WRITING – 5 MIN READING)

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Section A: This question is **compulsory** and must be attempted.
2. Sections B: Answer **TWO (2)** questions from this section.
3. This examination paper carries a total of **100 marks**.
4. Candidates must **not turn this page** until the invigilator tells them to do so.

SECTION A: QUESTION 1 IS COMPULSORY AND MUST BE ATTEMPTED

QUESTION 1

The Zambian Ministry of Transport and Logistics is embarking on a $500 million project to construct and upgrade major highways connecting Lusaka, Ndola, and Livingstone. This project, named "Smart Highways Zambia," is expected to improve trade routes, enhance safety through the integration of smart technologies (e.g., sensors and automated traffic control), and reduce travel time across the country.

The project involves multiple stakeholders, including government agencies, international contractors, local subcontractors, and civil society organizations. The project environment is complex due to factors such as land acquisition issues, community resistance in some areas, environmental concerns, and tight budget constraints.

As the project manager, you are tasked with ensuring that the project is delivered on time, within budget, and with minimal disruptions. You must consider the unique project environment in Zambia, including regulatory frameworks, cultural dynamics, and infrastructure challenges.

Prepare a comprehensive report addressing the following:

1. Analyze the project environment, including external and internal factors that could influence the success of the "Smart Highways Zambia" project. (15 marks)
2. Evaluate how the principles of the project management profession can be applied to manage stakeholders effectively and address conflicts that may arise during the project lifecycle. (15 marks)
3. Recommend strategies for ensuring successful project integration management to achieve seamless coordination between stakeholders, technologies, and project activities. (10 marks)
4. Discuss how project planning and control techniques can be used to monitor the project's progress and mitigate risks associated with delays and cost overruns. (10 marks)

(Total: 50 marks)

SECTION B: ATTEMPT ANY TWO (2) QUESTIONS IN THIS SECTION

QUESTION 2

Effective project selection is essential for aligning organizational objectives with resources and priorities. Using a Zambian context, describe how a public or private organization could apply project selection techniques to choose a project that contributes to national development goals, such as renewable energy, agriculture, or digital transformation. Your answer should include tools and frameworks used for project selection. **(25 marks)**

QUESTION 3

As a project manager, it is imperative that you take communication as a critical component of successful project management. Hence, you are required to describe and discuss a communication management plan for a large-scale project in Zambia, such as building a new university campus. Highlight key communication tools, methods for managing diverse stakeholder groups, and strategies for ensuring transparency and collaboration throughout the project lifecycle. **(25 marks)**

QUESTION 4

Risk management is a vital aspect of project success of which if not well handled, it may lead to the complete failure of a project. Being a seasoned project manager and risk expert, you are required to identify and analyze three major risks associated with implementing a technology-driven project in Zambia, such as a national e-government platform. Also propose effective risk mitigation strategies and explain how these strategies can contribute to the project's success.
(25 marks)

END OF EXAMINATION